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# The Morning Risk Briefing

EDITION 001

No. 001 — FRIDAY, JULY 31, 2026 — 25 ITEMS — TODAY FIRST + LOOKBACK — 12-SOURCE ROSTER

CFO BRIEF — THREE TAKEAWAYS, WRITTEN TO BE READ ALOUD

1. **Casualty severity:** a \$604M nuclear verdict hit C.H. Robinson this week; 2025 logged 149 such verdicts (\$25.1B). Worth re-testing our umbrella limits against that curve.
2. **Buyer's market:** commercial property rates fell 12% in Q2 (all lines –6%), and analysts doubt even a \$100B catastrophe would harden the market — a favorable renewal window.
3. **Cyber posture:** manufacturing was the most-attacked industry for a 5th straight year (27.7% of 2025 incidents) — the external case for our cyber tower.

TOP STORIES 1–8

## 01 C.H. Robinson hit with \$604 million nuclear verdict

TRUCK NEWS · LATE JULY 2026

A Dallas County jury awarded \$604M over a fatal multi-vehicle crash — among the largest verdicts ever in freight transportation.

**WHY IT MATTERS** — the number your fleet, auto liability, and umbrella limits will be measured against.

## 02 Q2 Global Insurance Market Index: rates fall 6%, property drops 12%

BEINSURE · Q2 2026 INDEX

Increased capital, cheaper reinsurance, and competitive pressure are all favoring buyers right now.

**WHY IT MATTERS** — hard numbers behind the soft market; leverage for your renewal conversations.

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### 03 **Global disaster losses dip below average as Venezuela quake and heatwaves signal rising risk**

RISK & INSURANCE · JULY 31

Natural disasters caused ~\$112B in economic losses in H1 2026; only \$44B was insured.

**WHY IT MATTERS** — a significant protection gap just as peak hurricane season begins.

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### 04 **Super El Niño will redraw global catastrophe risk**

INSURANCE BUSINESS AMERICA · JULY 31

The Atlantic hurricane threat eases while Pacific, wildfire, and flood exposures climb.

**WHY IT MATTERS** — the catastrophe map your property program is priced on is moving.

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### 05 **Most commercial property accounts arrive with a valuation gap**

INSURANCE BUSINESS AMERICA · JULY 31

Underinsured schedules risk coinsurance penalties when the claim comes.

**WHY IT MATTERS** — a quiet check worth running on plant and equipment values before renewal.

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### 06 **Midwest severe storms, wind, hail & tornadoes may rank as a top-10 severe weather loss**

ARTEMIS / AON · JULY 31

Aon says the Midwest severe-convective-storm event could land among the costliest weather losses on record.

**WHY IT MATTERS** — a direct watch item for Midwest plants and property schedules.

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## 07 **P&C market enters correction phase with significant rate relief**

RISK & INSURANCE · 2026

General and product liability show tentative stabilization in manufacturing, retail, and service segments as buyers see real rate relief.

**WHY IT MATTERS** — favorable timing to push on rate and terms at renewal.

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## 08 **\$100bn event may not be enough to cause a hard market, say Berenberg analysts**

ARTEMIS · JULY 31

Berenberg argues even a \$100B catastrophe may not be enough to turn the softening reinsurance market.

**WHY IT MATTERS** — buyer leverage should persist into the next renewal cycle.

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NUCLEAR VERDICTS & LITIGATION FUNDING 9–13

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## 09 **The largest nuclear verdicts of Q2 2026: social inflation continues**

ENLYTE · Q2 ROUNDUP

Enlyte's roundup of the quarter's largest verdicts; for scale, 2025 closed at 149 nuclear verdicts totaling \$25.1B across 28 states (Litigation Sentinel).

**WHY IT MATTERS** — this is the severity trendline your casualty pricing rides on.

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## 10 **North Carolina enacts first-in-the-nation litigation funding ban**

INSURANCE BUSINESS AMERICA

The Prohibit Litigation Investments Act restricts third-party investments tied to the outcome of civil proceedings.

**WHY IT MATTERS** — the first state ban of its kind; a template others may copy.

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## 11 **New Jersey Assembly passes funding-transparency bill; New Hampshire bill targets foreign funders**

PIA NORTHEAST BLOG · JULY 2026

NJ's A-2159 (Assembly-passed, not yet law) would force disclosure of third-party litigation funding; NH's introduced HB1384 would bar funding from foreign adversaries.

**WHY IT MATTERS** — disclosure momentum is building state by state.

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## **12      2026 marks a "turning point" in the war against litigation financing**

**INSURANCE BUSINESS AMERICA** · 2026 · STILL RELEVANT

CSAA's legal chief sees the tide turning as states move on outright bans and transparency rules.

**WHY IT MATTERS** — the legal environment driving casualty severity may finally be shifting.

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## **13      Groups push for federal court rule to disclose litigation funding**

**INSURANCE JOURNAL** · MARCH 24 · OLDER BUT CRITICAL

A coalition wants federal courts to require disclosure of funders' identity and financial stake in civil cases.

**WHY IT MATTERS** — federal disclosure would expose the money behind big-ticket suits nationwide.

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PARAMETRIC & ALTERNATIVE RISK   14–15

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## **14      Munich Re launches parametric earthquake insurance for corporates in Japan**

**ARTEMIS** · JULY 28

Seismic-trigger coverage promising faster payouts for corporate buyers.

**WHY IT MATTERS** — parametric is mainstreaming; worth asking brokers whether similar triggers could backstop business interruption.

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## **15      Two for one: when physics and finance intersect**

**INSURANCE JOURNAL** · JULY 27

The line between parametric and traditional indemnity is fading as specialty (non-admitted) carriers blend both into single programs.

**WHY IT MATTERS** — one-stop structures worth raising with your broker.

MANUFACTURING & WORKPLACE 16–22

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**16 Manufacturing: the most cyberattacked industry for the fifth straight year**

ACO INSURANCE 2026 MARKET OUTLOOK, CITING IBM X-FORCE

Manufacturers absorbed 27.7% of all cyber incidents in 2025 — more than any other industry.

**WHY IT MATTERS** — the argument for your cyber tower size, written by the attackers.

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**17 NHTSA probes 1.2 million Tesla vehicles over suspension failure risks**

INSURANCE JOURNAL · JULY 31

A preliminary investigation into suspension safety concerns across roughly 1.2 million vehicles.

**WHY IT MATTERS** — a live case study in product-liability and recall exposure at manufacturing scale.

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**18 Cyber firm Wiz says flaw could have exposed thousands of Microsoft cloud customers**

INSURANCE JOURNAL · JULY 31

A single cloud vulnerability with a mass blast radius across Microsoft customers.

**WHY IT MATTERS** — systemic cyber accumulation; the scenario dependent-business-interruption wording exists for.

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**19 Ransomware's new AI tactic could inflate cyber claims**

INSURANCE BUSINESS AMERICA · JULY 31

Attackers are using AI-driven pressure tactics to push victims into costly decisions.

**WHY IT MATTERS** — a tactic aimed at inflating claim severity, not just frequency.

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## 20 **Uncovered medical services are driving up workers' comp costs**

RISK & INSURANCE / WCRI · JULY 31

Durable medical equipment and services without fee schedules are consuming a growing share of comp payments.

**WHY IT MATTERS** — a specific, fixable cost driver to raise with your TPA.

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## 21 **How the war in Iran impacts legal contracts**

RISK MANAGEMENT MAGAZINE · JULY 22 · STILL RELEVANT

Warfare doesn't automatically trigger contract termination or excuse performance.

**WHY IT MATTERS** — a prompt to re-read force majeure language across supplier agreements.

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## 22 **Defining the discoverability and privilege of AI-generated materials**

RISK MANAGEMENT MAGAZINE · JULY 14 · STILL RELEVANT

Recent court decisions clarify when AI-generated materials are discoverable in litigation.

**WHY IT MATTERS** — an AI-governance flag as these tools spread through the business.

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LONDON MARKET & GLOBAL 23-25

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## 23 **European wildfires threaten broader economic losses**

CIR / GUY CARPENTER · JULY 31

Insured property losses remain modest, but the wider economic impact keeps expanding.

**WHY IT MATTERS** — supply-chain and contingent-BI exposure beyond the insured headline.

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## 24 **Lloyd's finds former CEO breached compliance rules**

LLOYDS.COM · JULY 22 · STILL RELEVANT

The Council concluded an undisclosed relationship created a perceived conflict of interest, breaching global compliance policy.

## 25 **Lloyd's full-year 2025 results: £10.6bn profit before tax**

LLOYDS.COM · FY 2025 · OLDER BUT CRITICAL

The Lloyd's market produced strong results with profit before tax of £10.6bn.

**WHY IT MATTERS** — strong results typically support capacity and competitive pricing; context for renewals.

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### Law.com — "Defusing America's Nuclear Verdicts Crisis"

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